China and South Africa (although with somewhat different motives) correctly view South Africa, with its relatively sophisticated financial and commercial infrastructure, as a logical gateway for Chinese economic expansion into Africa, with each country anticipating gains from combining their different mixes of the resources of status, local knowledge, and money.

Proposition 4. Collaborative financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when such cooperation promises to appeal to the domestic audience and increase the status of each country's current political leadership within its respective domestic political arena.

Participation in the BRICS is a plus in terms of domestic politics for leaders in each of the five member-states, although the group and its benefits are portrayed somewhat differently within each one. For autocratic regimes, with concentrated power and interests and relative stability in their leadership, it may be particularly appealing to use these "U.S. dollar–establishment-as-scapegoat" tactics to rally around the flag, while none of the three democratic powers has an urgent need to legitimate incumbent leaders by uniting the population in opposition to the West. Leaders in both the autocracies and the democracies employ their domestic presentation of the BRICS to focus on the high status accruing to their country as a member of an exclusive club of rising powers.

For China, the BRICS club meets a diverse array of domestic expectations. Chinese political leaders deliberately include components of China's diplomatic and foreign policy, such as BRICS collaboration, as a part of the Chinese Dream. BRICS collaboration also appeals to nationalists demanding more recognition and prestige of China's rise as it challenges existing global financial governance arrangements that are seen by the nationalists as unfairly holding China back. Chinese liberals, who support the financial reforms, welcome internationalization of the RMB. For Russia, the BRICS' collective financial statecraft enhances the wide legitimacy of Russian protection of its own sovereignty, which is guarded by the Kremlin. However, the BRICS are of marginal importance in Russian domestic politics. To the extent that they are mentioned, it is often in the context of the nationalist "stand up to the West" propaganda, while the regime does not widely advertise to the mass public its persistent efforts to play a larger role in Western institutions. In India, Brazil, and South Africa, the NDB and CRA are popular with visionary public-sector technocrats and the private financial community; bankers in all three